TOWN OF THUNDERBOLT
REGULAR MONTHLY MEETING
WEDNESDAY, MAY 8, 2024
6:00 PM

AGENDA HEARING

Public has five minutes per person to ask questions or comment on any agenda item.
Mayor Williams opened the public hearing up at 6 pm.

Beth Goette, 3006 Leonard St., suggested adding "gifted, foreclosed, sold" to the STR Amendment being considered. Ms. Goette also commented on the STR data showing 76 total STRs, 7 which are owner occupied. Ms. Goette thought the cap was 70. She asked who monitors the STR data.

Town Clerk Walker stated that Host Compliance/Granicus assists with monitoring, but the Town also relies on the residents to help make us aware of non-permitted STRs in Thunderbolt.

Council member Lavin asked who follows up on the STRs believed to be operating without a valid certificate.

Town Clerk Walker stated that the usual course of action is a letter generated by Host Compliance, which is followed up on by Code Enforcement.

Nicholas Patrick, 2821 Grant St., came to discuss the rezoning letter he received regarding the upcoming rezoning request on Whatley Ave. and Fishbait Tr. He stated there is not enough information on the letter. He asked what is being placed there, what does each zoning classification mean.

Clerk Walker defined the (I-P) classification and stated the request is to rezone to residential classification and combine the two lots into one.

Mayor Williams closed the public comment at 6:29 pm.

REGULAR MEETING

1. **Call to order** - Mayor Williams called the meeting to order at 6:30 pm.

2. **Roll Call by Presiding Officer with Invocation, followed by the Pledge of Allegiance**

   In Attendance is Mayor Dana Williams and Council Members: Larry Ward, Bethany Skipper-Greer, Edward Drohan, and Brooks Barbaree. Staff in attendance: Town Administrator Bob Milie, Police Chief, Sean Clayton, Police Lieutenant Brandon Runyon; Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman; Public Works representative, Ben Oliver; Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow; Accounts Payable Manager, Katina Spaulding; Utility Clerk, Renee Holmes; Town Clerk/Zoning Administrator, Matthew Walker.

3. **Approval of Amended Meeting Agenda (adding public hearing for request to rezone parcels, removing discussion regarding Cesaroni Park, Treasury Bonds, and removing Town Administrator report)**

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the amended agenda. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with a second by Council Member Crenshaw. The motion passed unanimously.**

4. **Approval of Minutes from Previous Meeting**:

Minutes of April 10, 2024

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to approve the meeting minutes of April 10, 2024. **Council Member Ward made the motion to approve with meeting minutes April 10, 2024. Council Member Crenshaw provided the second. The motions passed unanimously.**

5. **Presentation:**

a) Mayor Williams read the Asian American and Pacific Islander Heritage Month Proclamation.
b) Mayor Williams read the Municipal Clerks Week Proclamation and presented it to Town Clerk Matthew Walker.
c) Mayor Williams read the "Know Local-Go Local" business spotlight for June 2024. The businesses recognized in June are: River Supply, Safe Harbor Marina, Herb Creek Landscape Supply, and RNR Home Improvements.

6. **Finance Report:**

Shannon Brett presented the finance report. The Town is on track with expenses and revenues through April 2024.

7. **Consent Agenda:**

Mayor Williams opened the public hearing @ 6:48 pm regarding rezoning request (Item 7a only)

Pastor Andre Young came to speak regarding Whatley Avenue rezoning. He was informed that request is being heard on May 15, 2024 at the Planning and Zoning meeting.

Council member Drohan stated the area is undeveloped and bought up by individuals. He supports the request. Dr. Drohan is concerned with the area being undeveloped with no infrastructure. He is also concerned that the development on the City of Savannah side will cause the homeless/squatters to inhabit the area for which this request is located.

Mayor Williams closed the public hearing @ 6:54 pm.

a) Consideration to approve rezoning of 6 parcels for Michael Smith
Colorado Ave (4 parcels) & Clars Ave (2 parcels)

b) First Reading of Ordinance to Amend Zoning Map

c) Second Reading and Consideration to Approve STR Ordinance Amendment

d) Second Reading and Consideration to Approve Ordinance: Georgia Municipal Employees Benefit System

A motion was made by Council Member Ward to approve consent agenda items A, B, and D. Council Member Barbaree provided the second. The motion passed unanimously.

8. **Discussion Agenda:**

   a) Fence Ordinance Discussion and Recommendations

   Attorney Barrow read his recommendations for amending the Fence Ordinance. Attorney Barrow stated this is for consideration only.

   Council Member Drohan supports the recommended amendment.

9. **Department Report** – Written Reports Submitted

   by: **Police / Municipal Court / Neighborhood Watch – Sean Clayton, Chief of Police**
   Chief Clayton had nothing to add to his report. Mayor Williams thanked Chief Clayton and Thunderbolt Police Department for their professionalism. Mayor stated the Blessing of the Fleet was a great event and he is proud of the employees and officers for all their efforts.

   Fire –Fire Chief, Andrew Bateman
   Chief Bateman had nothing to add to his report. Chief Bateman has requested and scheduled a vehicle simulator training for July 30, 2024.

   Public Works Department – Ben Oliver, Public Works
   Ben Oliver had nothing to add to the report.

   Town Clerk – Matthew Walker, Town Clerk
   Clerk Walker had nothing further to add to his report.

10. **STR Report – Ashley Goodrich, Consultant**

    Ms. Goodrich presented her report on STR use in Thunderbolt and explained the data offered. Council member Ward suggested sending STR mail with return receipt requested to ensure delivery. Council member Ward also wants an excel sheet monthly showing fines, rentals, compliance, etc. Council member Crenshaw stated the report was very informative.

    Mayor Williams thanked Ms. Goodrich for her work in Thunderbolt.

11. **Legal Report** – Town Attorney, Charlie Barrow

    Nothing to report or discuss

12. **Mayor and Council –**

    Mayor Williams stated there were over 6,000 people at this year's Blessing of the Fleet. He thanked everyone for their hard work and thinks it keeps getting better every year.

    Dr. Drohan announced the Annual GMA Convention coming up in June 2024 and encouraged others to participate.

13. **Thunderbolt Museum**

    Anna Maria Thomas discussed the two weeks of garage sales in Town. She had art from local artist Jim Marsh and a book by author Beverly Jennings. Finches had a fundraiser breakfast which donated $110 to the Thunderbolt Museum Society.

14. **Executive Session-**

Council Member Ward made a motion at 7:43 pm to leave regular session to enter executive session to discuss Personnel, Property, or Litigation. Council Member Crenshaw seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Council Member Crenshaw made a motion at 8:20 pm to leave executive session to return to regular session. Council Member Drohan seconded. The motion passed unanimously.

Mayor Williams asked for a motion to adjourn the meeting. **Council Member Drohan made the motion with a second from Council Member Skipper-Greer. The motion passed unanimously.**

15. **Adjournment:**

The meeting adjourned at 8:21 pm.

Dana Williams, Mayor

Matthew D. Walker, Town Clerk

AFFIDAVIT

Personally appeared before the undersigned attesting officer, duly authorized to administer oaths, **Mayor, Dana Williams,** who, after being duly sworn, deposes and on oath states the following:

(1) I was the presiding officer of a meeting of the **Town of Thunderbolt** City Council held on the **8th** day **of May, 2024.**

(2) That it is my understanding that O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) provides as follows:

> *When any meeting of an agency is closed to the public pursuant to subsection (a) of this Code Section the chairperson or other person presiding over such meeting shall execute and file with the official minutes of the meeting a notarized affidavit stating under oath that the subject matter of the meeting or the closed portion thereof was devoted to matters within the exceptions provided by law and identifying the specific relevant exception.*

(3) The subject matter of the closed meeting or closed portion of the meeting held on the **8th** day of **May, 2024** which was closed for the purpose of discussing Real Estate, *Personnel and/or Legal* Matters was devoted to matters within those exceptions as provided by law.

(4) This affidavit is being executed for the purpose of complying with the mandate of O.C.G.A. 50-14-4 (b) that such an affidavit be executed.

This **8th** day of **May, 2024.**

Mayor, Dana Williams

Council Members

Sworn to and subscribed before me
this 8th day of **May, 2024.**

Notary Public

MATTHEW D WALKER NOTARY PUBLIC CHATHAM COUNTY, GA Comm. Exp. 10/04/26

SIGN IN SHEET

MEETING: Town Council **MEETING DATE:** May 8, 2024

NAME:	ADDRESS:
Beth Grotte	30016 Leonard Street
NICHOLAS PATRICK	2821 GRANT ST
PSTR ANDRE L. YOUNG	3301 WHATLEY AVE
Jo Anne Dickerson	3204 Gregg St